

Rammohan Sundaram of DDB Mudra Group, is revolutionizing the Media Industry

Online consumption of media is on a fast-growing trend. Each day, people are going online more to find what they are looking for. With faster network services and the inception of smartphones, online content consumption has been rapidly increasing globally.

Way back in the 1980's, it was never easy to visualize things - an era of the offline world. DDB Mudra group was incepted back then with 15 talented people, 500 square feet of room, and an insatiable hunger to be the best creative agency ever. That's how it all started on the 25th of March 1980.

Today, the DDB Mudra Group is one of India's most effective creative agencies. Driven by their dynamic philosophy and quality work, they have built a reputation for creativity that delivers results. Most importantly, they are known for the kind of creativity that touches lives and makes a difference.

Patience and perseverance are a deadly combination but that's what it takes to be a grandmaster

Rammohan Sundaram

Rammohan Sundaram heads the DDB Mudra media function across all touchpoints for the group responsible for client budgets over \$330M (RECMA) in P&L in India.

Ram is a CXO-level digital leader, has been an entrepreneur thrice, and successfully exited twice. His first venture NetworkPlay was sold to Bertelsmann AG's Gruner. His second venture was merged with SVG Media, which is now part of Dentsu Aegis Network. His last venture



Rammohan Sundaram
Country Head & Managing Partner –
Integrated Media

VelfieApp couldn't scale as planned and is parked.

He has held global leadership positions as CEO, MD, SVP, VP, and Director at organizations like C1X Inc., Reliance JIO, Ibibo Group (now part of MakeMyTrip.Com), Tribal DDB (Omnicom Group), Madison Communications, Jobsahead.Com (now part Monster.Com) and Indian Express.

He has also been Founding Chairman at ad: tech, iMedia, and TechCrunch in India and is credited for launching LinkedIn in India through the JVs he formed for NetworkPlay and PlatformPlay.

For some of his stellar achievements, he has won several awards across the globe including at Cannes, World Brand Congress, and CMO Asia. He has ranked 39th in 100 Impact Marketers for India in 2020-21. Recently in January 2022, he was named Most Inspirational Leaders of Asia by White Page International.

Mr. Ram also holds a Doctorate in Business Administration from S.P. Jain School of Global Management. Ram is a proud Bruins Alumni too, completed his

PGPX from UCLA Anderson School of Management. He holds double graduation in Engineering, a double master's in business administration and digital business. He has completed a residential Executive Management Program from HBS in Strategic Marketing Management also.

Talking about his future goals, Mr. Ram gave us a clear thought, "Having grown the business to over 15% in the pandemic year, we are determined to take the media business to new heights and 2022 has begun with a bang with some big wins in media including Life Insurance Council, Infosys, and Rajasthan Tourism.

His other plans include technology and data-led digital offerings for which DDB Mudra launched its Agency Trading Desk – Bingo, which is the first of its kind - a fully transparent platform.

Mr. Ram discussing about the goal is to lead the market with disruptive product offerings that will bring value for advertisers in one of the most commoditized advertising markets of the world.

Talking about challenges and how he overcame them, he told, there were many challenges. First was to get change and growth as mindsets across all team members, then bring about the necessary product changes keeping in mind the demography of the country and using that as an advantage to win businesses and grow.

Mr. Ram is optimistic about the media industry. He believes that the industry is robust but media and advertising are dependent on many factors including the economic growth of the country and hence brands should think long terms and not consider media and advertising as costs but as investments for the future. This mindset is critical for the betterment of the industry.